

Marsupials

A marsupial is a mammal with a pocket called a pouch for carrying its babies in.

Koala

Koalas look like little bears. They live in Australia and are the only animal that eats eucalyptus leaves. They are so hard to digest that koalas spend 19 hours of the day sleeping to let their tummies settle.

When the baby koala gets too big for the pouch, it clings to its mother's back instead.



Little devil

The Tasmanian devil is not much bigger than a small dog but is very aggressive. It is the biggest meat-eating marsupial and has such powerful jaws that it can eat an entire animal – bones and all!

More marsupials

Apart from a few that live in South America, almost all marsupials come from Australasia. They vary a lot in looks.



Dorian's tree kangaroo: this small kangaroo can climb trees.



Numbat: this marsupial has the most teeth of any mammal. It has 52.



Rabbit-eared bandicoot: is a burrower with big ears.

A kangaroo's front legs are

Bouncing marsupials

Kangaroos cannot walk. Instead they have enormous back legs that they use to jump everywhere. They can move very fast just by leaping.

Become an expert

52-53 Australia
128-129 The world of mammals